MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準1級
リーディングトレーニング

第1回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜18	短文の語句空所補充
2	19〜24	長文の語句空所補充
3	25〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

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氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) Cutting maintenance spending may temporarily save money, but it could ( ) the damage to the aging railway.

1 exacerbate **2** authenticate **3** cultivate **4** reimburse

(2) The minister's explanation was subjected to intense ( ) by journalists who questioned every figure.

1 courtesy **2** scrutiny **3** prosperity **4** sympathy

(3) The committee gave ( ) approval, reserving the right to reconsider when more evidence became available.

1 inherent **2** defiant **3** provisional **4** redundant

(4) The negotiator tried to ( ) the conflicting demands of the two groups without dismissing either side.

1 contaminate **2** deteriorate **3** interrupt **4** reconcile

(5) The evidence remains ( ); it is too weak to justify a definite conclusion.

1 inconclusive **2** indispensable **3** imminent **4** impartial

(6) The firm had to write off its investment when the rapid change in technology made its equipment ( ).

1 plausible **2** obsolete **3** vigilant **4** intricate

(7) The editor rejected the allegation because it was based on ( ) rather than verifiable facts.

1 compliance **2** consensus **3** conjecture **4** compensation

(8) The small hospital proved remarkably ( ), continuing essential services despite repeated power failures.

1 extravagant **2** reluctant **3** superficial **4** resilient

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(9) The contract contains a (　　) allowing either party to withdraw if the required permit is refused.

1 clause　**2** quota　**3** syndrome　**4** tribute

(10) The speaker's claim was met with (　　) because it contradicted well-established observations.

1 nostalgia　**2** skepticism　**3** hospitality　**4** ingenuity

(11) Rather than impose a rigid formula, the policy gives local authorities considerable (　　) in allocating funds.

1 erosion　**2** hostility　**3** discretion　**4** scarcity

(12) The official tried to (　　) responsibility by blaming a computer error, although he had approved the figures himself.

1 endorse　**2** retain　**3** confer　**4** evade

(13) A lengthy legal dispute could (　　) the organization's limited resources before the case reaches court.

1 deplete　**2** articulate　**3** consolidate　**4** revive

(14) The supposed distinction between the two categories is (　　); the same cases can easily fall into both.

1 unanimous　**2** arbitrary　**3** indigenous　**4** adjacent

(15) The laboratory adopted strict procedures to (　　) the risk of contaminating the samples.

1 magnify　**2** prolong　**3** mitigate　**4** disguise

(16) Although the witness remembered the general sequence, her recollection of the exact dates was (　　).

1 unerring　**2** abundant　**3** compulsory　**4** fragmentary

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(17) The mayor came under fire for attempting to (　　) the council and approve the project without a vote.

1 bypass　**2** uphold　**3** consult　**4** convene

(18) The company was forced to (　　) its promise after discovering that the product could not meet the advertised standard.

1 take after　**2** go back on　**3** look up to　**4** come across

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

The Silence in the Archive

Historical collections are sometimes treated as though they were transparent windows onto the past. A researcher asks a question, locates the relevant papers, and extracts an answer. Yet the existence of a document reflects a chain of decisions: someone had to produce it, someone had to retain it, and an institution eventually had to consider it worth preserving. Groups whose daily activities generated few written records may consequently be difficult to study, even when their contribution to a community was substantial.

Consider a project reconstructing the history of a neighborhood market. Official files might contain detailed records of licenses and inspections, while offering almost nothing about informal arrangements through which traders shared transport or helped a sick colleague. If researchers relied exclusively on official files, they could (19). What was easiest to document would acquire disproportionate importance simply because it had survived in an accessible form.

Oral interviews can help broaden such a project, but they do not provide an uncomplicated solution. People may interpret earlier experiences through the concerns of the present. Different accounts may disagree without either speaker deliberately misleading the interviewer. (20), recordings should be accompanied by information about when and under what circumstances they were made. This enables later users to assess the accounts instead of treating them as context-free statements.

An honest archive therefore makes its own limitations visible. It can identify gaps, explain selection policies, and preserve disagreements rather than forcing every account into a single version of events. This does not make historical research impossible. On the contrary, recognizing how a collection was assembled allows researchers to (21). The aim is not to abandon evidence but to ask more precise questions of it.

(19)

1 discover that all informal practices were illegal
2 eliminate the need to consult other sources
3 mistake administrative visibility for social significance
4 establish a complete account of every trader's life

(20)

1 Even so
2 For instance
3 On the contrary
4 For this reason

(21)

1 evaluate what the surviving material can and cannot support
2 assume that every missing document once existed
3 replace all written evidence with present-day opinion
4 remove conflicting accounts from public access

A Standard Is Not a Setting

When a public agency purchases a digital service, adopting a technical standard can appear to resolve the question of accessibility. A supplier certifies that its product complies, the certificate is filed, and the agency proceeds with installation. Standards are indispensable because they establish common expectations that would otherwise have to be negotiated separately for every purchase. However, a certificate describes a product under specified conditions, not every future interaction between that product and its users.

Imagine a booking system that works correctly when tested in isolation. During installation, an agency adds a short time limit, requires documents available only as scanned images, and places essential instructions on another website. Each decision may seem administratively convenient. Taken together, they can create obstacles that were absent from the original test. A compliant product has not necessarily produced (22).

User testing after installation is therefore essential, but it must be organized carefully. Inviting only experienced staff to complete familiar tasks is unlikely to reveal the difficulties faced by someone using assistive technology or encountering the process for the first time. Agencies need feedback from people whose circumstances differ, and a procedure for acting on that feedback. (23), collecting complaints without assigning responsibility for resolving them merely documents exclusion rather than reducing it.

This does not mean that technical standards should be discarded. They provide a necessary baseline and make suppliers accountable for features within their control. The problem arises when meeting a baseline is treated as the end of the agency's responsibility. Accessibility is sustained through procurement, configuration, testing, and maintenance. An effective approach consequently requires agencies to (24), rather than regard accessibility as a property that can be purchased once and then forgotten.

(22)

1 a reason to abolish common standards
2 an accessible service in actual use
3 a certificate describing its original features
4 an administrative decision about its supplier

(23)

1 By contrast
2 Until then
3 Indeed
4 Regardless

(24)

1 transfer all responsibility to first-time users
2 test a service only before signing a contract
3 prevent suppliers from using shared specifications
4 treat it as an ongoing organizational commitment

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Who Benefits from a Quieter Street?

Reducing traffic on a residential street may seem an uncomplicated improvement. Fewer vehicles can mean less noise, cleaner air, and more space for people walking or cycling. Yet the evaluation of a traffic scheme depends on where its boundaries are drawn. A street that becomes quieter may sit beside another that receives the diverted vehicles. An assessment limited to the first street can therefore tell a convincing but incomplete story.

Suppose a district introduces barriers that prevent through-traffic from using several residential roads. Initial monitoring shows a sharp decline in vehicles inside the area. Residents living near the barriers report that children can cross more easily and that conversations are no longer interrupted by engine noise. These are genuine benefits, not merely perceptions to be dismissed. However, residents along the main roads outside the area report longer queues. They question why their experience is absent from the first evaluation.

One response is to enlarge the monitoring area. This is necessary, but a larger average alone may still obscure important differences. If a substantial improvement for several thousand people outweighs a smaller deterioration for a few hundred, the overall figure may look favorable. That calculation does not by itself establish whether the distribution of costs is acceptable, especially if those facing deterioration already experience the greatest pollution. Choosing a measurement boundary is therefore not a neutral substitute for considering fairness.

Timing introduces another complication. Drivers may initially follow familiar routes and later change their journey, travel at another hour, or choose another means of transport. The first week may consequently exaggerate permanent disruption. Conversely, waiting for people to adapt cannot justify disregarding persistent problems indefinitely. An evaluation should state in advance when it will be repeated and which findings would trigger a change. Otherwise, every unfavorable result can be described as temporary and every favorable result as final.

A credible process combines measurements with ways for affected people to challenge the interpretation. Residents may identify a school entrance that monitors have missed or explain why a supposedly convenient alternative route is unusable for someone with limited mobility. Their accounts do not replace traffic counts, but they can reveal what the counts fail to capture.

The choice is not simply between accepting every scheme and rejecting any scheme with uneven effects. It is between treating evaluation as a defense of a completed decision and using it to revise that decision. A project can retain its original aims while adding protection for neighboring roads, adjusting delivery access, or removing a barrier that causes disproportionate harm. A quieter street is worth pursuing, but the claim of success becomes stronger when it accounts for people beyond that street.

Who Benefits from a Quieter Street? — Questions

(25) What is the author's main criticism of evaluating only the roads inside a traffic scheme?

1 It can exclude adverse effects on neighboring roads.

2 It necessarily exaggerates improvements reported by local residents.

3 It makes it impossible to count vehicles accurately anywhere.

4 It assumes that all barriers must eventually be removed.

(26) According to the third paragraph, why might a favorable overall figure still be insufficient?

1 It cannot include data from different streets.

2 It does not settle whether burdens are distributed fairly.

3 It always gives greater weight to the poorest residents.

4 It proves that pollution has declined for everyone.

(27) Which approach to evaluation does the author support?

1 Treating all early disruption as evidence that a scheme must end.

2 Postponing review until nobody reports any remaining problem.

3 Setting review conditions and using both measurements and residents' knowledge to make revisions.

4 Using personal accounts instead of collecting traffic counts.

Learning from a Pilot Without Copying It

A successful pilot project is often presented as a miniature version of a future policy. If a service works for a small group, expanding it appears to be a matter of securing enough money and reproducing the same arrangement elsewhere. This picture is appealing to decision-makers because it turns uncertainty into an apparently manageable problem of scale. Unfortunately, the conditions that make a pilot succeed may be precisely those that cannot be reproduced simply by increasing its budget.

Consider a pilot designed to help residents navigate complicated housing applications. A small team operates from a familiar community center, and its coordinator has long-standing relationships with both local families and officials. Staff can telephone a particular official to clarify an unusual case, and residents who distrust formal agencies may approach the coordinator because a neighbor recommends her. None of these features is captured by a description that says only "advice provided at a local center."

When the service is expanded, new offices may be established quickly, but relationships take time. The original coordinator may also have exercised considerable judgment about which rules could be interpreted flexibly and which required strict compliance. A standardized handbook can preserve some of this knowledge, but not necessarily the ability to recognize a new situation. If policymakers copy only the visible procedure, they may reproduce its appearance while losing the mechanisms that made it effective.

This does not render pilots useless. Rather, it changes what should be learned from them. Evaluation needs to identify not only whether an outcome improved but also how the improvement occurred. Were staff reducing delays because they simplified paperwork, because they knew whom to contact, or because the pilot received exceptional attention from senior officials? These explanations imply different prospects for expansion. A process that depends on an unusual level of senior attention may be harder to sustain than one based on a broadly applicable change in application forms.

There is also a danger in selecting only the most enthusiastic communities for a pilot and then treating their results as representative. Such communities may contribute unpaid labor, adapt buildings, or solve problems informally. These contributions can be legitimate strengths of the pilot, but they should not disappear from the account of its costs. Expansion to areas without the same resources may require additional funding or a different design.

A useful next step may therefore be a deliberately varied second trial, rather than immediate nationwide adoption. This trial can test the service in places with different staffing, relationships, and levels of local support. Some adaptations should be permitted, provided the essential mechanism and the reason for each change are documented. Uniformity of every visible detail is not the same as fidelity to the project's purpose.

Ultimately, the most responsible claim for a pilot is rarely that it has eliminated uncertainty. It has made certain assumptions more testable and exposed conditions that deserve attention. Policymakers can then decide which elements should be preserved, which require investment, and which must change. Scaling a project intelligently is a process of learning across settings, not transporting a finished object from one place to another.

Learning from a Pilot Without Copying It — Questions

(28) Why does the author introduce the housing-application example?

1 To argue that housing advice should never be standardized.

2 To demonstrate that every local service needs national funding.

3 To show that community centers are cheaper than digital services.

4 To illustrate how hidden relationships and judgment may underpin visible procedures.

(29) What distinction is emphasized in the fourth paragraph?

1 Measuring an improved outcome is different from understanding the mechanism behind it.

2 Senior attention is always less expensive than changing forms.

3 Evaluation should focus exclusively on unsuccessful pilots.

4 Application forms have no influence on service delays.

(30) What problem may arise when pilots are conducted only in highly enthusiastic communities?

1 The communities will necessarily reject any paid staff.

2 Their unpaid contributions may be overlooked when estimating what expansion requires.

3 Their results cannot contain any useful evidence.

4 The pilots will automatically become more expensive than national programs.

(31) What does the author suggest about a second trial?

1 It should reproduce every visible detail without alteration.

2 It should be limited to locations identical to the first.

3 It should examine varied conditions while documenting adaptations and essential mechanisms.

4 It should continue until all uncertainty has disappeared.